

Binding a Contested Nation: National Attachment and Cross-Domain Solidarity in Taiwan

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Abstract

This paper examines how national attachment shapes reciprocal solidarity across issue domains. We conceptualize solidarity as the willingness to share burdens out of a sense of mutual obligation to overcome collective adversity. Because the costs of solidaristic action vary across domains, we argue that reciprocal solidarity is domain specific, and national attachment can serve as a cross-domain binding force. Using a nationally representative survey conducted in Taiwan in 2025, we compare reciprocal solidarity in the welfare and warfare domains. We find that reciprocal solidarity is higher in the warfare domain and the two domains show distinct distributions. Across both domains, national attachment is consistently associated with stronger reciprocal solidarity. Moreover, reflecting Taiwan's contested nationhood, the effect of national attachment is moderated by national identity in the welfare domain but not in the warfare domain, suggesting that the relationship between attachment and solidarity depends on policy context and conceptions of national identity.

Keywords: national attachment, national identity, reciprocal solidarity, warfare, welfare, Taiwan

I. Introduction

Solidarity refers to the mutual attachment among members of a community and the reciprocal obligations they owe one another (Bayertz, 1999). In the social solidarity literature, national identity is widely regarded as a key factor that binds society together, as it enables members of the polity to perceive themselves as part of a larger collective. This shared sense of belonging is thought to foster interpersonal trust, enhance sympathy and empathy toward those in need, and encourage solidaristic attitudes and behaviors (D. Miller, 1995; David Miller, 2017; David Miller & Ali, 2014). Such effects are considered especially important in times of crisis, when societies require higher levels of solidarity to overcome collective challenges (Ariely, 2024; Tamir, 2020a, 2020b).

Despite widespread normative agreement on the importance of national identity for fostering solidarity, empirical findings remain divided. While some studies identify a positive association between national identity and solidarity (Sumino, 2014; Galle & Fleischmann, 2020), others find no such relationship (Shayo 2009), or that such a positive correlation is conditional on national context (Dufresne et al., 2014; Johnston et al., 2010; David Miller & Ali, 2014). The divergent empirical findings can partially be attributed to that solidarity is often operationalized in different ways across studies. Different operationalization strategy may capture different constituent elements of solidarity, but not necessarily its core component, leading to divergent empirical findings.

Moreover, existing research on national identity and solidarity has focused primarily on whether national identity, compared to other forms of social identity (e.g., race and ethnicity), can serve as a more inclusive basis for fostering greater solidarity within national borders (Charnysh et al., 2015; Johnston et al., 2010; Robinson, 2016; Singh, 2015; Transue, 2007). However, this literature has paid little attention to contexts in which the very definition of the nation is itself contested. In polities where nationhood is still contested, meaning that individuals within national borders still have different national identities, what factors can strengthen citizens' willingness to support one another and sustain collective institutions? These questions remain largely unexplored in the existing literature.

In this paper, we begin with theories of solidarity to identify the necessary components of solidaristic behavior and distinguish solidarity from other forms of prosocial action, such as charity or philanthropy. Drawing on normative discussions of solidarity, we identify that mutually obligated reciprocity is what differentiates solidarity from instrumental cooperation or strategic exchange. Thus, unlike most studies that measure solidarity by asking whether individuals support a policy or are willing to pay more for a policy, we measure solidarity in whether individuals feel compelled to act because others are also bearing costs. This approach provides a direct operationalization of solidarity as a moral obligation to engage in joint action, rather than in preference expression or cost–benefit calculation.

In addition, we argue that even when the definition of nationhood is still contested, individuals can nonetheless develop strong emotional attachment to the political community. National attachment can serve as a binding force even in a contested nation, fostering higher levels of social solidarity despite persistent disagreement over nationhood. This paper uses Taiwan as a case, a political community that still struggles with its nationhood. Situated at the periphery of China, Taiwan's struggle for nationhood has been a battle against China (Achen & Wang, 2017; Nachman, 2025). Taiwanese' quest to build a distinctive national identity against being subsumed into a Chinese identity is an effort both "anti-colonial" and "anti-hegemonic" (Chang & Liu, 2026). For a century, the definition of nationhood continues to be a contested field.

Taiwan also presents a case that confronts two major threats to societal survival. On the one hand, Taiwan ranks among the world's most rapidly aging societies, placing significant strain on the long-term sustainability of its welfare state (Hayutin, 2022). On the other hand, China's increasingly aggressive military behavior and explicit ambition to annex Taiwan pose a direct threat to the very existence of the state. Leveraging the distinctiveness of these dual threats, this study compares citizens' solidaristic attitudes across two sharply different domains, namely, the welfare and warfare domains, to assess whether national attachment operates as a cross-domain foundation of reciprocal solidarity.

Drawing on a nationally representative telephone survey fielded in 2025, the paper reports several findings. First, both the level and distribution of solidaristic attitudes vary across issue domains. Reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain is significantly higher than in the welfare domain. Second, national attachment is consistently associated with stronger reciprocal attitudes across issue domains, suggesting that a sense of national belonging and the perception of oneself as an integral part of a larger political community serve as the adhesive binding the community together and fostering stronger reciprocal solidarity.

Third, reflecting Taiwan's contested nationhood, we find that the effect of national attachment is moderated by national identification in the welfare domain, but the moderating effect is absent in the warfare domain. Specifically, the positive association between national attachment and reciprocal solidarity in welfare is significantly stronger among individuals whose national self-identification is not exclusively Taiwanese, and this marginal effect diminishes as national identity becomes more exclusively Taiwanese. It indicates that national attachment and an exclusively Taiwanese national identity can substitute each other to generate reciprocal solidarity in welfare. In the warfare domain, both national attachment and an exclusively Taiwanese identity have positive and independent effects on reciprocal solidarity in warfare. The result signals that to generate the highest level of reciprocal solidarity in warfare, both an exclusively Taiwanese national self-identification and stronger attachment to the nation are indispensable.

The paper contributes to the literature in three ways. First, starting from a theory-informed definition of solidarity, the paper derives operationalizable indicators of solidarity that allow for

systematic empirical testing. It highlights mutually obligated reciprocity as a core element of social solidarity and can be understood as the attitude that one feels obligated to contribute. In doing so, this paper advances the study of solidarity by connecting its empirical measurement with its normative conceptual root and demonstrating how insights from political philosophy can be used to specify the necessary constitutive elements of solidarity for empirical testing purposes.

Second, much of the existing literature studies single-domain solidarity, mostly in the welfare domain. This paper demonstrates that solidarity is a domain-specific phenomenon. Because collective adversities differ in nature and impose varying costs for solidaristic action, it is premature to assume that the positive association between national attachment and reciprocal solidarity generalizes across policy domains. This paper shows that what is needed instead is an empirical approach that disaggregates domain-specific reciprocity, allowing for a more precise understanding of how national attachment shapes overall societal solidarity.

Finally, the paper demonstrates that national attachment is a key factor bolstering reciprocal solidarity across issue domains at the societal level, even in a contested nation. This is good news for democracy. Contemporary democracies face an expanding range of internal and external challenges, and it is widely argued that reciprocal solidarity functions as a societal resource that strengthens community cohesion (Sangiovanni 2015; Miller 2017), which constitutes a critical societal foundation for democratic resilience (Merkel and Lührmann 2021). The paper sheds new light on how to build democratic resilience from the bottom up, suggesting that national attachment can play a positive role in strengthening the social foundations of democratic resilience.

We organize the article as follows. We begin by introducing the case of Taiwan, a contested nation facing two major societal challenges. In Section 3, we review the normative literature on solidarity and explain why solidarity should be understood as a domain-specific phenomenon. In Section 4, we develop our theoretical argument for why national attachment can serve as a source of social cohesion even in contested nations. Section 5 presents the research design, followed by the empirical results, discussion, and conclusion.

II. Taiwan: A Contested Nation with Dual Challenges

Taiwan, as a non-Western democracy, still struggles with the definition of its nationhood. A key source of this contest lies in Taiwan's historical and geopolitical position on the periphery of an empire: China. Like many small polities situated adjacent to empires, questions of national identity can be constantly challenged as empires have expansionist tendencies to impose their identity on peripheral territories and to expand their borders to include peripheral territories. For instance, in Ukraine, Russian identity has been in competition with the Ukrainian identity and, for a long time, a significant portion of the population self-identifies as both Russian and Ukrainian

(Veira-Ramos & Liubyva, 2020), making identity issues the main political cleavage in Ukrainian politics.

The same dynamic can be observed in Taiwan. Any discussion of nationhood in Taiwan inevitably requires addressing its relationship with China, the source of its contestation. In Taiwan, ethnically speaking, 94% of the people are Han Chinese who migrated from Southern China over the last few centuries. As such, a considerable amount of the population considers themselves Chinese. Today, a key national identity debate concerns the extent to which a distinctive Taiwanese national identity exists and is different from the Chinese identity. The rise of Taiwanese nationalism and the quest for self-determination are both anti-colonial and anti-hegemonic endeavors (Chang & Liu, 2026).

Since democratization, survey data shows that exclusive Taiwanese identity has increased steadily over time. In 1992, only 18% identified exclusively as Taiwanese, while 72% identified either exclusively as Chinese or both. In 2025, over 60% identify exclusively as Taiwanese (Election Study Center, 2024). Although we see the growth of exclusively Taiwanese identity, there is still a considerable number of people holding dual or exclusively Chinese identities, and short-term identity fluctuations continue to occur. While international sporting events can temporarily reduce dual identity and strengthen exclusive identity (Huang, Sun, and Lin, 2026), individuals can also move away from exclusive Taiwanese identity out of rational strategic calculation (Wang, Yeh, Wu, and Chen, 2025). In 2025, still 34% of the population possesses dual or an exclusive Chinese identity (Election Study Center, 2024). In sum, what defines Taiwan's national identity and the extent to which this identity is distinct from ethnic Chinese identity still lie at the core of Taiwan's political cleavage until today.

Despite the contested nature of its nationhood, Taiwan faces major challenges that threaten the survival of the state and its collective institutions. Owing to rapid population aging and the persistent military threat from China, the case of Taiwan exemplifies collective adversity in dual dimensions.

On the welfare front, Taiwan is aging at a relatively fast pace (Hayutin 2022), leaving governments with little time to prepare or recalibrate policy responses. At the same time, the legacy of the developmental state has shaped welfare regimes in the region into what scholars describe as productivist welfare states, characterized by relatively limited social spending and a strong emphasis on economic growth and labor market participation (Holliday 2000). As population aging accelerates, the gap between growing welfare demands and the constrained supply embedded in existing welfare architectures has widened further. Sustaining the welfare state under these conditions inevitably requires the state to extract more financial resources from society. Debates over redistribution and which social groups should pay more and which should benefit less intensify, constituting the first pressure domain for solidarity.

On the warfare threat, Taiwan continues to face intensifying military threats from China. Not only have Beijing's tactics diversified, both the frequency and magnitude of China's military pressure have grown significantly. Beijing has escalated its activities in the Taiwan Strait in recent years. Chinese military aircraft have crossed the median line, entered Taiwan's Air Defense Identification Zone (ADIZ), and carried out increasingly frequent and expansive military exercises. Routine PLA aircraft circumnavigations around Taiwan have also become normalized. China's persistent and credible threat to take Taiwan by force is a real threat. Should this materialize, Taiwan's democratic institutions and security would be fundamentally compromised.

As a result, Taiwan faces a growing imperative to prepare its citizens psychologically for the possibility of war. One way to gauge such preparedness is through citizens' willingness to engage in self-defense (Wang & Eldemerdash, 2023; Wu, 2025). A society's readiness for self-defense is not limited to its capacity to fight. It also encompasses the mental preparedness and resilience of civil society should war unfortunately occur. Fostering Taiwan's war readiness vis-à-vis China and building psychological resilience across civil society is therefore essential for comprehensive preparedness (Yen, 2024). However, the threshold associated with cultivating a sense of willingness to fight is much higher than that of willingness to pay for defense. How to thicken reciprocal solidarity on the warfare front, in particular the willingness to bear the costs of going to war, is a challenge.

These dual collective adversities function as ticking time bombs. For Taiwan's democracy to remain resilient, a crucial question would be how to cultivate both warfare solidarity and welfare solidarity. China's military aggression toward Taiwan presents an external threat, and the costs associated with showing solidarity to fight collectively against China's invasion is also high. The welfare domain presents a within-border adversity where collective action primarily entails increased financial contributions. While redistribution may be politically contested, the personal costs of solidaristic behavior are lower, relatively speaking.

III. Solidarity and Domain-Specific Obligated Reciprocity

Existing literature has pointed to social solidarity as a vital resource that supports community cohesion (Sangiovanni 2015; Miller 2017). A more solidaristic community holds positive implications for other desirable societal outcomes (Merkel and Lührmann 2021; Croissant and Lott 2025). Solidarity concerns the mutual attachment between individuals and mutual obligations toward each other within the community (Bayertz, 1999). A community formed through shared culture or shared identity, due to cultural or historical roots, provides the foundation for solidarity, and solidarity in turn reinforces and deepens the cohesiveness of that community.

Sangiovanni (2015) treats solidarity as a form of collective action and conceptualizes it as a joint action among members of the same political community to overcome significant adversity (e.g., poverty, repression, etc.) together. The joint action occurs in a manner that members are

willing to bear costs to share each other's fate, with the moral expectation of reciprocity. In other words, one acts out of a sense of mutual obligation, not strategic calculation. Solidarity is the "mutual responsibility" between members of the same community (van Parijs, 2024). The motivation is therefore normative rather than rational, and in essence, reciprocity is the cornerstone of solidaristic behaviors (Miller, 2017; Sangiovanni, 2023). Therefore, we define reciprocal solidarity as the willingness to act due to mutual obligation because others are also bearing costs, not strategic cooperation. Highlighting the reciprocal nature of solidaristic acts allows us to distinguish solidarity from other altruistic behaviors, such as charity, philanthropy, or sympathy (van Parijs, 2024). Reciprocal solidarity should contribute to thickening societal ties and cohesion, which further expand societal resilience capacity.

Welfare states are most commonly understood as institutional expressions of reciprocal solidarity (Miller, 2017). The state's involvement in pooling and redistributing resources, as opposed to leaving these functions solely to private communities, materializes and formalizes solidaristic commitments (Béland and Hansen, 2000; Baldwin, 1990; Bayertz, 1999). Reciprocal solidarity in the welfare context refers to the willingness of individuals to share risks with one another so that the burdens of misfortune are distributed equally across members of the same risk pool (Baldwin, 1990). Solidaristic behavior can emerge under substantial uncertainty because, as Dryzek and Goodin (1986, p.31) suggest, uncertainty expands people's moral horizons and compels them to imagine themselves in others' circumstances. In such conditions, individuals become more willing to share risks with others. The uncertainty in the post-war era contributed to the emergence of the modern welfare state in the United Kingdom (Dryzek and Goodin, 1986; Obinger, Petersen, and Starke, 2018).

Although reciprocal solidarity is often discussed in the context of the welfare state and typically refers to the redistribution of risks or financial resources, it is not a concept confined to welfare arrangements alone. Beyond the welfare state, reciprocal solidarity encompasses a broader set of diverse moral relationships within a community. Accordingly, rather than treating solidarity and reciprocity as general traits, several scholars emphasize the importance of distinguishing among the different uses of solidarity and the various moral dimensions to which it refers. Bayertz (1999) argues that community can vary in kind and scope, so the specific form that solidarity takes is contingent upon the particular community to which it refers. For instance, solidarity in welfare states means redistributing financial resources to those in need, but solidarity in social movements means "emotional cohesion between the members of these social movements (p.16)." Yen and Yeh (2025), for example, argue that even within the welfare state context, solidarity takes two forms. One is institutional solidarity, which is an individual's willingness to support the formal institutional welfare arrangements; the other is social solidarity, which is an individual's willingness to bear costs in joint actions addressing a common risk. Underneath institutional solidarity, what solidaristic support means may vary between welfare states and across policy domains.

Thus, building a resilient society from bottom up requires viewing reciprocal solidarity as a multidimensional phenomenon. Yet most empirical studies measure and test solidarity within a single domain, most commonly the welfare state domain. This focus is understandable, as the welfare state is often regarded as the most institutionalized expression of solidarity in modern societies. However, whether solidarity developed in one issue domain can extend to other domains remains an empirical question. Do individuals who feel obligated to act reciprocally in one domain necessarily exhibit the same willingness in other domains? Are the factors that foster solidarity in one context have similar effects in other contexts?

Because the nature of collective adversity varies across issue domains, the costs associated with reciprocal action are also not uniform. As a result, the threshold for acting reciprocally should differ by context. To assess a society's overall level of reciprocal solidarity, analysis must therefore begin with domain-specific investigations before identifying the factors capable of binding citizens together to act solidaristically across domains. One of the objectives of this paper is to explore solidarity of and beyond the welfare domain and explore the factors that can forge cross-domain solidarity.

IV. National Attachment as the Social Glue in a Contested Nation

In the nationalism literature, national attachment measures the strength of one's emotional attachment to their nation. Stronger national attachment indicates that national identity is more salient and personally meaningful to the individual. The salience of one's national identity is a central dimension of the broader concept of nationalism (Mylonas and Tudor, 2021).

Yet, national identity is only one of the many social identifications that an individual may possess. The relative importance of national identity may vary across individuals and contexts. National identity often becomes a more salient identification when a crisis happens (Kuehnhaness, Holm, and Mahieu, 2021). Political elites can also mobilize and leverage nationalist sentiment during such periods. By contrast, in normal times, national identity may be highly salient for some but relatively unimportant for others, creating interpersonal variation in their feeling of connections to their national identity.

The connection between national attachment and social solidarity is rooted in the discussion of liberal nationalism (D. Miller, 1995; David Miller, 2006; Tamir, 2020). This tradition emerged from normative debates over the compatibility of liberalism and nationalism (Mylonas and Tudor, 2021). Prominent communitarian political theorists argue that individuals do not live or make political decisions in a social vacuum. Rather, they are embedded within national communities that provide shared identity and culture. Normative goals of liberalism, including distributive justice and even a well-functioning welfare state, presuppose a national community in which people feel connected and obligated to one another. As such, national identity is not viewed as being in tension with liberal values. It constitutes an important social foundation for realizing liberal normative goals.

Within the liberal nationalism tradition, researchers have examined the role national membership can play in fostering solidarity in multicultural and multiethnic societies. They argue that stronger connections to national membership promotes greater solidarity and stronger willingness to engage in solidaristic behavior (Sangiovanni, 2015). National identity is not a passive attribute of an individual but a powerful motivating force that creates an “ethical community” (Johnston et al., 2010, p. 352). Shared national identifications supply the motivational fuel for solidaristic action because individuals understand themselves as members of a collective (Forst, 2024). A shared sense of national identity connects members through a perceived common destiny and generates moral obligations among them (Miller, 2017). National attachment directly captures the emotional bonding with co-nationals that is essential for generating a strong sense of mutually obligated reciprocity (Ariely, 2024; David Miller & Ali, 2014; Rapp, 2022).

Although the normative debate over liberal nationalism has subsided in recent years (Mylonas and Tudor, 2021), the question of how national attachment shapes solidarity remains theoretically and empirically important. Despite the theoretical prediction, empirical analysis testing the effect of national attachment yields inconclusive results, hinting that more research is needed. Empirical evidence from Japan and Belgium shows that strong national identification is associated with stronger support for redistribution (Sumino, 2014; Galle and Fleischmann, 2020). In ethnically diverse societies, the salience of national self-identification, compared to other subordinate social identification (e.g., ethnic identity), creates a more inclusive sense of community conducive for redistribution and social trust (Charnysh et al., 2015; Galle & Fleischmann, 2020; Robinson, 2016). On the contrary, Shayo (2009) finds that strong national identification led to lower support for redistribution in 26 democracies, at both individual and aggregate levels. Other studies find that the effect of national identity on solidarity depends on national contexts (Johnston et al., 2010; David Miller & Ali, 2014; Rapp, 2022). For example, in the case of Canada, the positive effect of national identification on the sustainability of the welfare state is mainly pronounced in public health care, but not in the areas of redistribution or social security (Johnston et al., 2010; Dufresne, Jeram, and Pelletier, 2014). As Johnston et al. (2010, p.351) put it, “National identity may not have any general tendency to strengthen support for redistribution, but it may do so for those aspects of the welfare state seen as having played a particularly important role in building the nation or in enabling it to overcome particular challenges or crises.” In sum, the relationship between national membership salience and social solidarity might alter depending on the national contexts.

Much of the existing literature testing the effect of national attachment on pro-social behaviors studies the linkage in settings where national identity is one of the main identifications competing with other types of identifications (e.g., national versus ethnic, regional, or subnational identities). Their central focus is on whether national identification can provide a more inclusive membership base for social solidarity. However, it is unclear in settings where the definition of nationhood is still contested, meaning that people within the territorial border still have different national self-identification, can national attachment still have positive effect on social solidarity?

In such cases, the core question is not simply how salient national identity is relative to other identities, but whether a distinctive nation exists and what defines that nation. Does competing nationhood undermine solidarity?

For societies still engaged in processes of nation-building with competing answers to the question of “who we are”, it is essential to analytically distinguish the effects of national attachment and national self-identification. Analytically, in contested nationhood, it is possible to have two people both having strong emotional attachment to the nation, but their national self-identification is different. In the same vein, possessing a clearly and exclusively defined national identity may carry independent implications for solidarity, regardless of the strength of national attachment. Conflating the two risks obscuring important variation in how solidarity is generated, particularly when the meaning of the political community is itself under dispute.¹

For instance, in the case of Taiwan, one study finds that winning international sport events, while increasing nationalist sentiment, can simultaneously increase the proportion of people identifying exclusively as Taiwanese and the proportion identifying exclusively as Chinese. Rather than producing convergence around a single national identity, boosted national sentiment appears to reinforce competing definitions of nationhood (Huang, Sun, and Lin, 2026).

We reckon that, although in a contested nation the definition of the nation remains debated, individuals can nevertheless develop a strong emotional attachment to it. In particular, when measures avoid invoking contested labels or taking a position on how the nation should be defined, they can still capture individuals' emotional attachment to the political community. We argue that this form of national attachment can still strengthen social solidarity, even when the boundaries and definition of the nation itself remain unsettled.

At least three causal mechanisms exist through which strong national attachment can enhance social solidarity. First, individuals can develop a sense of shared fate. Strong nationalist sentiment can lead individuals to “link their fate to the larger community” and perceive the interests of the nation as an extension of their own interests, thereby fostering a sense of interconnected destiny. In particular, this form of emotional attachment helps reduce conflicts among social groups of diverse cultural or ethnic origins and strengthens support for pro-social behaviors (Singh, 2015; Transue, 2007). In multi-ethnic societies, national identity provides a superordinate identity that transcends narrower ethnic boundaries. By drawing a broader boundary

¹ To be noted, Some empirical studies examines how different conceptions of nationhood (i.e., the criteria used to define full membership in the nation) shape the scope of social solidarity (David Miller & Ali, 2014; Ward & Denney, 2025). For example, Miller and Ali (2014) distinguish between civic and cultural conceptions of identity, explicitly addressing whether national membership is defined by shared history and culture, common ancestry, or adherence to shared political values. Yet, these distinctions concern more with “conditions of national membership”, which means that the attention is on which criteria to be used to determine who belongs or who deserves to be the “full” member of the community, not the very nature of whether the national identity exists or not.

of political membership, national identity can integrate diverse groups into a shared political community and thereby facilitate solidaristic behavior (Singh, 2015; Robinson, 2016).

Second, stronger national attachment can stimulate greater sympathy toward the disadvantaged members of the political community (D. Miller, 1995; David Miller, 2006). As existing research notes, sharing a sense of national belonging implies recognizing one another as members of a community of shared fate and entails moral obligations toward fellow members that go beyond basic humanitarian concern. This affective foundation encourages empathy and sympathy toward those in need and helps consolidate social bonds as well as the moral legitimacy of solidarity.

Third, national attachment is often regarded as an important social adhesive that promotes interpersonal trust, which in turn enhances solidarity. In Miller's account (1995; 2017), because solidarity requires members of a political community to act collectively with others whom they do not personally know, a certain degree of trust that unfamiliar others will comply and act alongside oneself is necessary for solidaristic action to emerge. Through strong national attachment, individuals are more likely to perceive others as "one of us," reducing uncertainty and defensive attitudes and thereby increasing interpersonal trust, which is a crucial precondition for the emergence and maintenance of social solidarity. To assess the validity of this theoretical account, this paper explicitly tests the independent effect of interpersonal trust on reciprocal solidarity. Higher levels of interpersonal trust are expected to facilitate reciprocity by reducing uncertainty about others' willingness to contribute and by lowering the perceived risks associated with collective action.

In territories where the definition of the nation remains contested, national attachment may still serve as a source of solidarity. However, competing conceptions of national identity imply different boundaries of national membership and, consequently, different understandings of who belongs within the community of solidarity. In Taiwan, for example, whether an individual identifies as Taiwanese, Chinese, or both reflects different conceptions of the nation's boundaries. These alternative conceptions define different solidaristic communities and therefore shape with whom individuals believe reciprocal obligations should be shared. Whether the boundary of a particular solidarity domain aligns with an individual's perceived national community is likely to influence their willingness to act solidaristically. Consequently, both the scope of one's perceived national membership and the strength of one's emotional attachment to the nation may independently, or interactively, shape solidarity. Moreover, their relative importance may vary across policy domains, depending on how the relevant solidarity community is defined.

In Taiwan's dual threat context, we reckon that the solidarity community in the healthcare domain under Taiwan's National Health Insurance is relatively inclusive, encompassing all legal residents regardless of nationality or national identity. By contrast, the boundary of solidarity in the warfare domain is more exclusive because it directly raises the question of with whom, and for whom, one is willing to fight and sacrifice life. We therefore expect the effects of national

attachment and national self-identification to vary across domains. To disentangle these relationships, we will estimate interaction models to examine whether the association between national attachment and solidarity differs across individuals holding different national identities, and whether these moderating effects themselves vary between the welfare and warfare domains.

Building on existing research and considering its shortcomings, this article examines whether national attachment has a positive effect on cross-domain, reciprocity-based solidarity in Taiwan, a context in which the very definition of nationhood remains contested. Specifically, we test the proposition that solidarity is a domain-specific attribute, and that national attachment and national identity are analytically distinct yet related constructs, both of which may contribute to higher levels of social solidarity in Taiwan.

V. Research Design

To answer whether citizens' attitudes in domain-specific reciprocal solidarity vary and the extent to which national attachment can be binding forces enhancing reciprocal solidarity across issue domains, we use the data from the 2025 Taiwan Society Political and Moral Values Survey. It is a nationally representative cross-sectional survey conducted by the Survey Research Center, Department of Political Science, National Chung-Cheng University, between March 7-16, 2025. The survey population covers people aged 18 or over living in Taiwan during the survey period. There are 1,245 completed observations. After excluding observations with missing values in variables used in the analysis, the final sample size is 1,025.

In this survey, we try to be conscious about several empirical strategy choices. First, a review of the existing literature shows there is no consensus on how solidarity is operationalized across studies. Existing empirical studies employ a wide range of proxies for solidarity, many of which, in our view, fail to capture its necessary constituent element of solidarity, which may lead to diverging empirical findings. Second, the existing literature largely focuses on testing the effect of nationalism on solidarity in the welfare domain. However, it is premature to assume that the positive association between national attachment and solidarity observed in the welfare domain necessarily extends across other issue domains. Collective adversities differ in nature and impose varying costs for solidaristic behaviors. Whether individuals who feel obligated to act reciprocally in one domain are also willing to do so in other domains therefore remains an open empirical question to be answered.

To capture solidarity motivated by reciprocity, rather than an observable outcome, we constructed our dependent variables of interest – *reciprocal solidarity in welfare* and *reciprocal solidarity in warfare* – by asking the respondents whether they agree or disagree with the following statements: “If many people are willing to accept higher NHI premiums to help others, I would feel guilty if I opposed the increase ” (*reciprocal solidarity in welfare*) and “If a cross-Strait war

breaks out and many people are willing to defend the country, I would feel guilty if I refused to defend the country” (*reciprocal solidarity in warfare*). This operationalization allows us to capture the mutually obligated reciprocity necessary for solidaristic behaviors across different issue areas. Both dependent variables, which originally presented in a 6-point Likert scale (from 1 “strongly agree” to 6 “strongly disagree”), were inversely coded and linearly rescaled to a 0-1 metric (with a value of 1 indicating the strongest reciprocal solidarity and a value of 0 indicating the weakest reciprocal solidarity) to facilitate interpretation.

The first independent variable of interest is national attachment, conceptualized as the degree of emotional attachment to national identification. *National attachment* measures the extent to which the respondent agrees to the following statement: “If someone insulted my country, I would be very angry or retort to the person,” presented in a 6-point Likert scale (from 1 “strongly agree” to 6 “strongly disagree”). The question wording provides a measure of emotional attachment to one's country without invoking contested national labels or symbols. This allows us to isolate the effect of national attachment from that of national identity in Taiwan, where the definition of the nation remains contested. The other independent variable of interest is the definition of national identity. *National identity* is measured by answers to the question, “In our society, some people identify themselves as Taiwanese, some as Chinese, and some as both. On a scale from 1 (Taiwanese) to 10 (Chinese), with 5 meaning half Taiwanese and half Chinese, what number best describes how you see yourself?”² We inversely coded the variable and linearly rescaled it into a continuous variable ranging from 0 (“exclusively Chinese”) to 1 (“exclusively Taiwanese”). Both independent variables of interest are reverse-coded and linearly rescaled to continuous variables ranging from 0 to 1, with higher values indicating greater intensity of each construct.

On control variables, we include respondents’ demographics, partisanship, belief in meritocracy, and attitudes toward context-specific perceived risks. Respondents’ demographics include *sex* (categorized as: female, male), *level of education* (categorized as: junior high school and below, high school and vocational education, college, graduate), *personal monthly income* (linearly rescaled into a 0-1 variable), *self-reported health status* (linearly rescaled into a 0-1 metric, a higher value indicating better health), and *number of children* (linearly rescaled into a 0-1 variable). *Partisanship* was coded into four categories, including pan-green, pan-blue, white, and independent.

We also measure social trust because it is one of the intermediate variables identified by previous research that could drive solidarity (David Miller, 2017). *Social trust* is captured by

² It should be noted that, although the mathematical midpoint of the 10-point scale is 5.5, the survey question explicitly anchors the value of 5 as the “half Taiwanese and half Chinese” position. The distribution shows that, despite a global mode of 1, a distinct local frequency peak occurs at 5, suggesting respondents’ cognitive alignments with this prompt.

answers to the following question: “In general, do you think most people can be trusted, or is it better to be cautious when dealing with others?” also ranging from 1 (“very trusting”) to 6 (“very cautious”). Social trust is also reverse-coded and linearly rescaled to a continuous variable ranging from 0 to 1, with a higher value indicating stronger social trust.

We argue perceived risk in specific policy domains may influence people’s tendency to engage in reciprocal behaviors within those domains, as a perception of crisis can lead to solidaristic action (Ariely, 2024). Therefore, we control for domain-specific perceived risks. In the analysis of reciprocal solidarity in welfare, we controlled for respondents’ *perceived risk in NHI’s bankruptcy*, measured by “Do you think the National Health Insurance will go bankrupt?”; in the analysis of reciprocal solidarity in warfare, we include respondents’ *perceived risk in war*, measured by asking respondents “Do you think a cross-Strait war will break out?” Both variables, which originally used a 6-point Likert scale from 1 “definitely will” to 6 “definitely not”, were inversely coded and linearly rescaled into a variable ranging from 0 to 1, with higher values indicating a greater perceived risk in each domain.

Belief in meritocracy is associated with reciprocal behaviors because individuals who attribute their achievements to personal talent, ability, and effort tend to de-emphasize mutual assistance, thereby diminishing their inclination toward reciprocal actions (Atria et al. 2020). The question used to construct variable *belief in meritocracy* is “Some people say, ‘What I have comes largely from the contributions of everyone in society,’ while others say, ‘What I have comes mostly from my own effort.’ Which view do you agree with more?” (from 1 “strongly agree with ‘from everyone’s contributions’” to 6 “strongly agree with ‘from my own effort’”). The variable was also inversely coded and linearly rescaled into a 0-1 metric, with higher values indicating stronger meritocratic belief.

We first examine and compare the average degrees and distributions of reciprocal solidarity across different issue domains to see whether people’s solidaristic attitudes vary across issue domains. Then, we employed multiple ordinary least squares (OLS) regressions with robust standard error estimation to test whether national attachment and national identity respectively or jointly shape individual solidarity across issue domains. Finally, we include interaction terms of national attachment and national identity to examine how the effect of the former is conditioned by the latter. The analyses were performed by Stata 17.

VI. Empirical Results and Discussion

Table 1 presents descriptive statistics summarizing the sample’s characteristics. It shows that the overall levels of reciprocal solidarity differ across the two policy domains. The reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain (mean=0.62) is significantly higher than that in the welfare domain (mean=0.47), a contrast further illustrated in Figure 1. Furthermore, the distributions of

the two domain-specific reciprocity (Figure 2) exhibit distinct patterns. These empirical results suggest that reciprocal solidarity is domain-specific rather than monolithic.

[insert Table 1 here]

[insert Figure 1 and Figure 2 here]

We then turn to examine the factors driving reciprocal solidarity across issue domains. Table 2 presents the results of the OLS regressions of reciprocity in welfare and in warfare, respectively. We present simplified results here to facilitate comparison; the full models are in Tables S2 (welfare) and S3 (warfare) in the Supplement. There are eight regression models of reciprocity in welfare and in warfare, respectively. Models 1 and 2 are simple regressions on *national attachment* and *national identity*, respectively, without controlling for any other variables. In Models 3 to 4, we further include control variables to examine whether the relationships between domain-specific reciprocity and the three independent variables change after considering other confounders. Model 5 includes all independent variables without control variables, and Model 6 is the full model that includes all independent and control variables.

Several findings can be drawn from Table 2. First, national attachment is consistently associated with reciprocal solidarity across different models in both the welfare and warfare domains, aligning with the theoretical prediction that greater emotional attachment to national identification serves as the moral fuel to create an ethical community pursuing collective interests. This empirical finding also confirms and echoes results from other contexts, which show that more attached to the Taiwanese identity are willing to sacrifice self-interest for collective goals and to support socially costly behaviors, such as participation in social protest (Chen & Yen, 2017; Yen et al., 2021).

[insert Table 2 here]

In addition, national identity also shows a positive association with reciprocal solidarity across issue domains. Respondents whose understanding of national identity is more Taiwanese than Chinese tend to display higher levels of reciprocal solidarity across domains. However, the magnitude of this effect is consistently smaller than that of national attachment. In fact, the effect of national identity does not reach statistical significance in the full model (M6) for welfare reciprocity. Compared to the welfare domain, the effect of national identity is systematically higher in the warfare domain. Cross-domain comparison indicates that individuals whose national self-identification is more Taiwan oriented are more likely to perceive threats and adversities originating from China's military aggression as collective challenges confronting "us," thereby activating a stronger sense of mutual obligation to act reciprocally.

The Divergent Driving Forces under Internal and External Adversity

Taken together, our analyses show that national attachment and national identity are distinct yet interconnected drivers of reciprocal solidarity. Given their theoretical overlap, their effects may operate independently, function as partial substitutes, or vary depending on the nature of the collective adversity to be overcome. For instance, among individuals whose national identity is not exclusively Taiwanese but includes varying degrees of Chinese identification, is the effect of national attachment on reciprocity the same? Conversely, among individuals with the strongest national attachment, does the specific nature of their national identity exert a differential impact on their willingness to engage in reciprocal, solidaristic actions? Accordingly, we further examine how national identity moderates the effect of national attachment in shaping reciprocal behavior across issue domains.

To investigate these complex dynamics, we incorporate an interaction term between national attachment and national identity. We classified respondents into two groups: those with the strongest national attachment (rescaled national attachment = 1) as “strong national attachment” and those with weaker national attachment as “weak national attachment”. This allows us to discern the mechanisms through which these forces interact to shape reciprocity under divergent forms of adversity. The full regression results are in Table S4 in the online appendix. We only show the visual results here. We found that, as shown in Figure 3, for individuals with high levels of national attachment, national identity plays a negligible role in shaping reciprocal solidarity in welfare. However, among those with lower levels of national attachment, a stronger Taiwanese-oriented national identity serves as a critical substitute, significantly bolstering their willingness to take reciprocal solidarity in the welfare domain. This suggests that in the context of internal adversity, either a strong emotional attachment to the nation or a clear Taiwanese identity is sufficient to sustain reciprocal solidarity in welfare.

[insert Figure 3 here]

In contrast, as shown in the right panel of Figure 3, both national identity and national attachment exert independent and positive effects on reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain. While national attachment motivates reciprocal solidarity by emotionally linking individuals’ personal fate to the collective well-being of the nation, the notion of a more Taiwanese national identity reinforces reciprocal solidarity in warfare. Together, these two dimensions contribute to stronger reciprocal solidarity when the polity confronts external threats.

The result also points to the direction that the nature of adversity plays a role here. In the context of internal adversity, such as welfare provision, reciprocal solidarity is grounded in a domestic social contract in which the precision of communal boundaries may be less critical. What really matters is how much one views the collective wellbeing as one’s own wellbeing. The more one links their fate to the national wellbeing, the stronger they feel obligated to support others and contribute to the national wellbeing. Variations in national boundary definitions primarily affect the aggregate size of the solidarity community, so long as members within that community

continue to act reciprocally toward one another. It is only among the weak nationalists, a more Taiwan-centered definition of national identity serves as a substitute binding force reminding citizens of mutual obligations with the national boundary.

In contrast, in the domain of external adversity, such as warfare, the source of adversity lies outside the political community. Externally generated threats to the territory therefore reactivate and reinforce the salience of territorial boundaries among those within them. Under such conditions, the boundary of the solidarity community becomes paramount. It delineates an existential question: whom one is willing to fight for and with whom one identifies as a comrade-in-arms.

This distinction is especially consequential in the Taiwanese context, where China's persistent military aggression renders questions of national boundary and collective belonging ever-present. In this setting, the boundary is not merely administrative but deeply political. As a result, not only do individuals with stronger national attachment exhibit higher levels of solidaristic resolve, but those whose national identity is more Taiwan-centered are particularly responsive to adversities that directly threaten the territory. Consequently, individuals who define national identity in increasingly Taiwanese terms display higher levels of reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain.

VII. Conclusion

Because social solidarity plays a crucial role in facilitating a wide range of socially beneficial behaviors, understanding its foundations carries important normative and practical implications. A more solidaristic society is one in which members are mutually committed to a shared future, reciprocate one another's actions, and are willing to bear costs for one another. A theory-driven conception of solidarity therefore centers on reciprocal obligation, and recognizes that the level and expression of solidarity may vary across policy domains. Yet existing research has largely examined the relationship between national attachment and solidarity within the welfare domain, overlooking important variation across domains. Moreover, it has almost exclusively tested this relationship in settings where the definition of the nation and national identity is relatively uncontested.

Using Taiwan as a case, this paper systematically examines whether national attachment can extend social solidarity beyond welfare politics. We show that reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain shows distinct distributional patterns, and that citizens express higher levels of reciprocal solidarity in the warfare domain. Moreover, our findings demonstrate that national attachment is a powerful motivational force that binds members of a political community together and increases the degree of mutually obligated reciprocity across issue domains. Even in contexts such as Taiwan, where the very definition of the nation remains contested, the emotional

attachment to the nation and the perception that one's personal fate is linked to its collective well-being are sufficient to induce reciprocal solidarity.

More importantly, by incorporating the warfare domain, this paper empirically tests the effects of national attachment beyond the welfare context. Doing so strengthens our confidence in arguing that national attachment can function as a positive force for cultivating overall societal solidarity, rather than being confined to redistributive politics alone. This finding resonates with earlier scholarly discussions emphasizing that even though nationalism comprises multiple dimensions and can be measured in different ways, emotional attachment to national identity captures the degree of collectiveness within a political community and is likely the aspect most closely related to social solidarity (David Miller & Ali, 2014). Other dimensions of nationalism (e.g., uncritical patriotism) may not carry the same positive implications for solidaristic attitudes or behaviors.

Our findings also carry important policy implications. They suggest that it is possible to foster social solidarity even in polities where the definition of the nation remains contested. Rather than attempting to resolve competing conceptions of nationhood, policymakers can cultivate solidarity by appealing to a shared emotional attachment to the political community while avoiding symbols, labels, or narratives that are associated with competing definitions of the nation. In doing so, it may be possible to generate the societal foundation necessary for solidarity without requiring consensus over the meaning of nationhood itself.

For future research, one promising direction is to examine how contextual factors interact with individual-level attributes to shape reciprocal solidarity. It is often argued that value systems in many Asian societies are more collectivist in orientation, and such collective-oriented values may influence how individuals perceive obligations toward others and what is considered due to individuals for society as a whole (Yeh & Hsieh, 2025). To enhance the generalizability of this argument, future studies should test the proposed mechanisms in societies characterized by more individualist value orientations. Comparative research across different cultural and institutional contexts would be particularly valuable for disentangling the relative influence of contextual-level factors vis-à-vis individual-level determinants of reciprocal solidarity.

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Table 1. Descriptive statistics (n=1,025)

	Mean (S.D.)	Freq. (%)
Reciprocal solidarity in welfare	0.47 (0.35)	
Reciprocal solidarity in warfare	0.62 (0.36)	
National attachment	0.78 (0.28)	
National identity	0.79 (0.27)	
Social trust	0.37 (0.30)	
Personal income	0.19 (0.19)	
Self-reported health status	0.66 (0.21)	
Number of children	0.13 (0.25)	
Perceived NHI bankruptcy risk	0.47 (0.31)	
Perceived war risk	0.43 (0.25)	
Belief in meritocracy	0.69 (0.31)	
Sex		
Female		517 (50.44%)
Male		508 (49.56%)
Age group		
<30		126 (12.29%)
30-39		133 (12.98%)
40-49		224 (21.85%)
50-59		223 (21.76%)
60-69		168 (16.39%)
>=70		151 (14.73%)
Years of education		
Junior high and below		105 (10.24%)
Senior high and vocational schools		396 (38.63%)
College		390 (38.05%)
Graduate school		134 (13.07%)
Work status		
Full-time		495 (48.29%)
Part-time		67 (6.54%)
Employers		93 (9.07%)
Not in labor force		370 (36.10%)
Partisanship		
Independent		396 (38.63%)
Pan-green		362 (35.32%)
Pan-blue		191 (18.63%)
White		76 (7.41%)

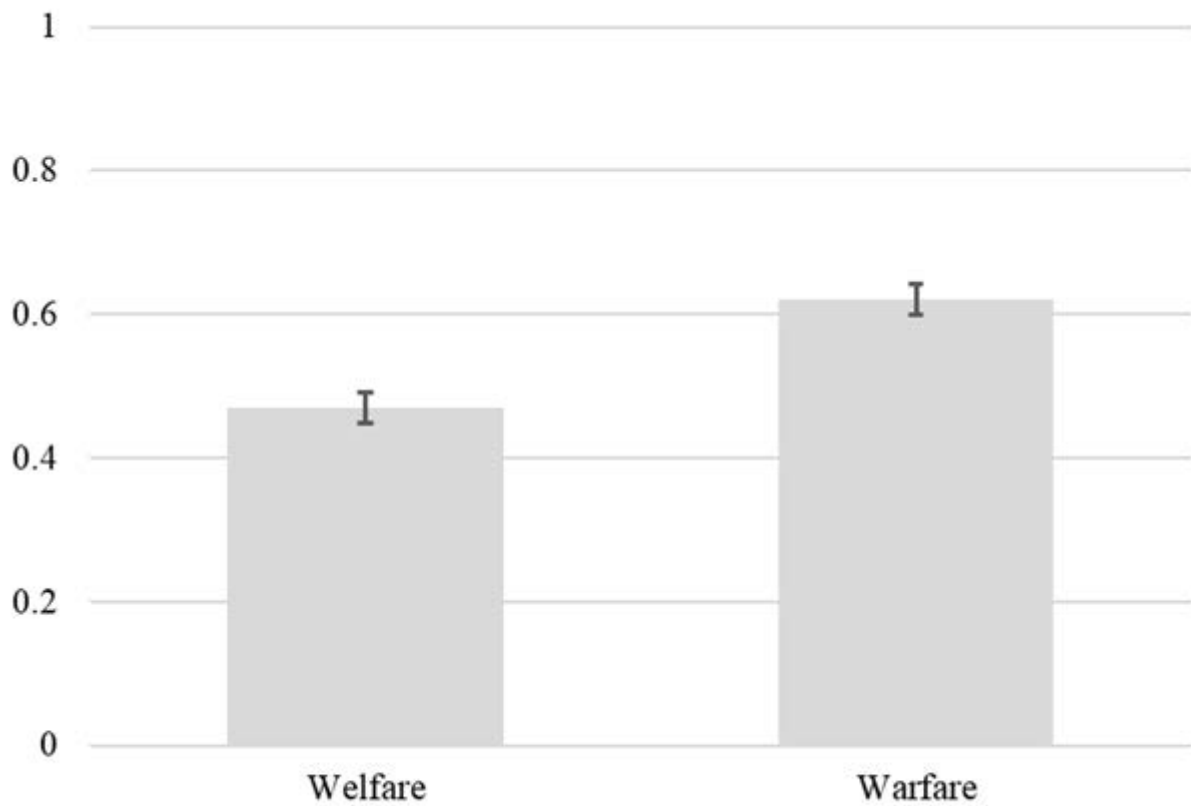
Table 2. OLS Regression of Domain-specific Reciprocal Solidarity on National Attachment and National Identity (Simplified)(n=1,025)

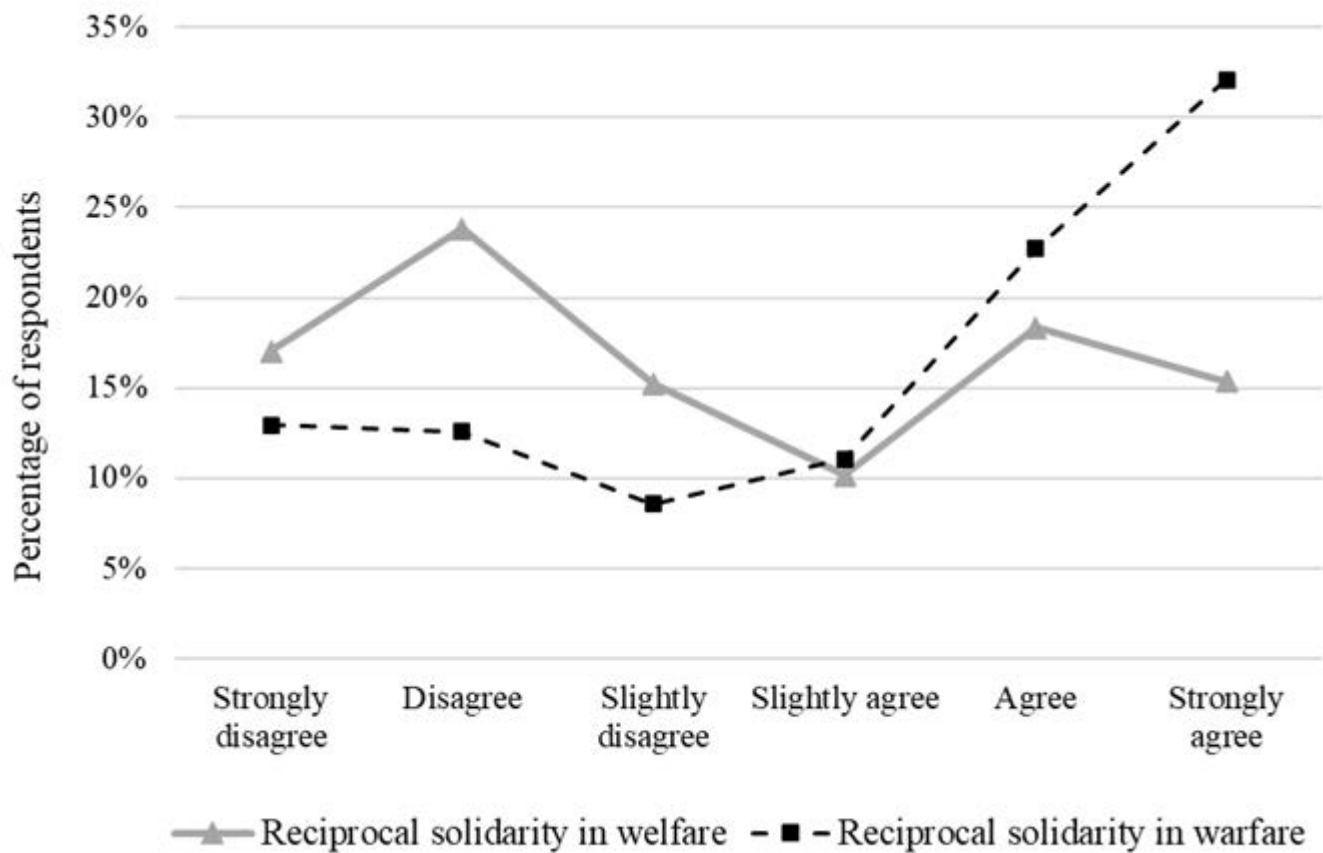
Reciprocal Solidarity in Welfare	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
National attachment	1.052*** (0.200)		0.800*** (0.212)		0.201*** (0.040)	0.156*** (0.042)
National identity		0.593** (0.206)		0.466* (0.234)	0.100* (0.041)	0.085 (0.046)
Constant	2.527*** (0.161)	2.875*** (0.172)	2.547*** (0.382)	2.467*** (0.420)	0.234*** (0.043)	0.241** (0.085)
Control variables	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Adjusted R-squared	0.027	0.008	0.051	0.041	0.032	0.054
Reciprocal Solidarity in Warfare	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
National attachment	1.730*** (0.206)		1.424*** (0.216)		0.320*** (0.041)	0.273*** (0.043)
National identity		1.580*** (0.218)		1.084*** (0.252)	0.286*** (0.043)	0.201*** (0.049)
Constant	2.783*** (0.170)	2.876*** (0.186)	3.037*** (0.377)	2.629*** (0.428)	0.151** (0.043)	0.246** (0.084)
Control variables	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Adjusted R-squared	0.070	0.057	0.132	0.110	0.116	0.148

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Mean of reciprocal solidarity





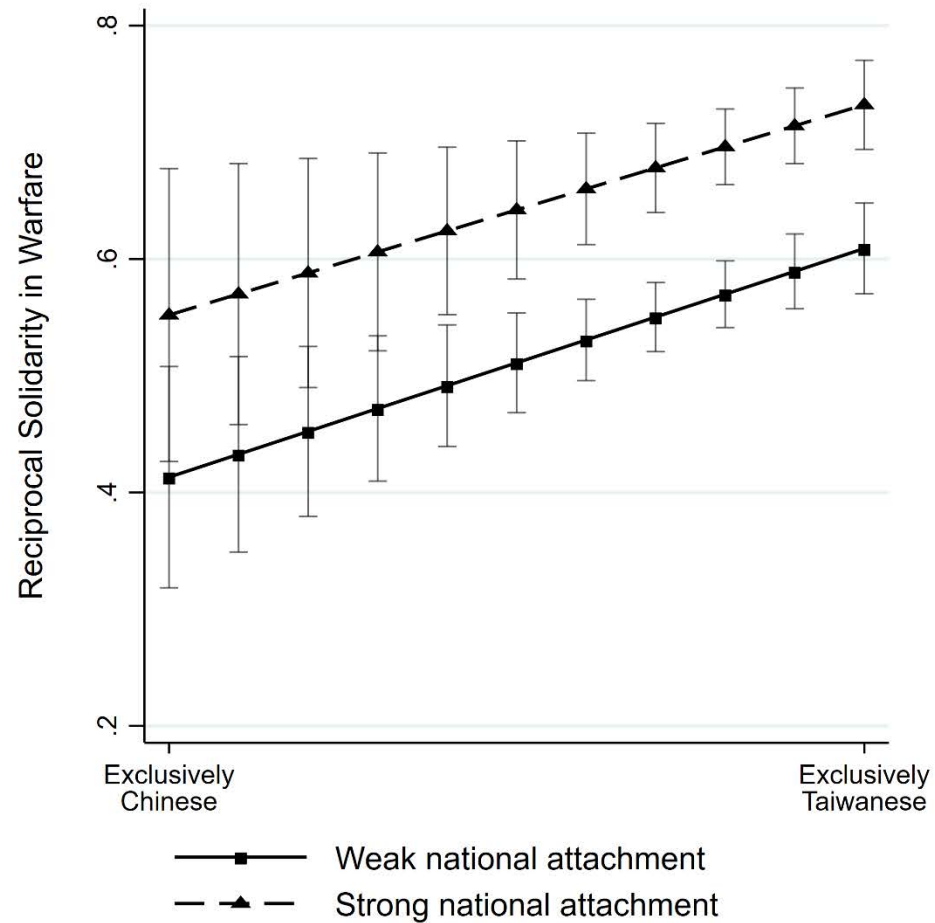
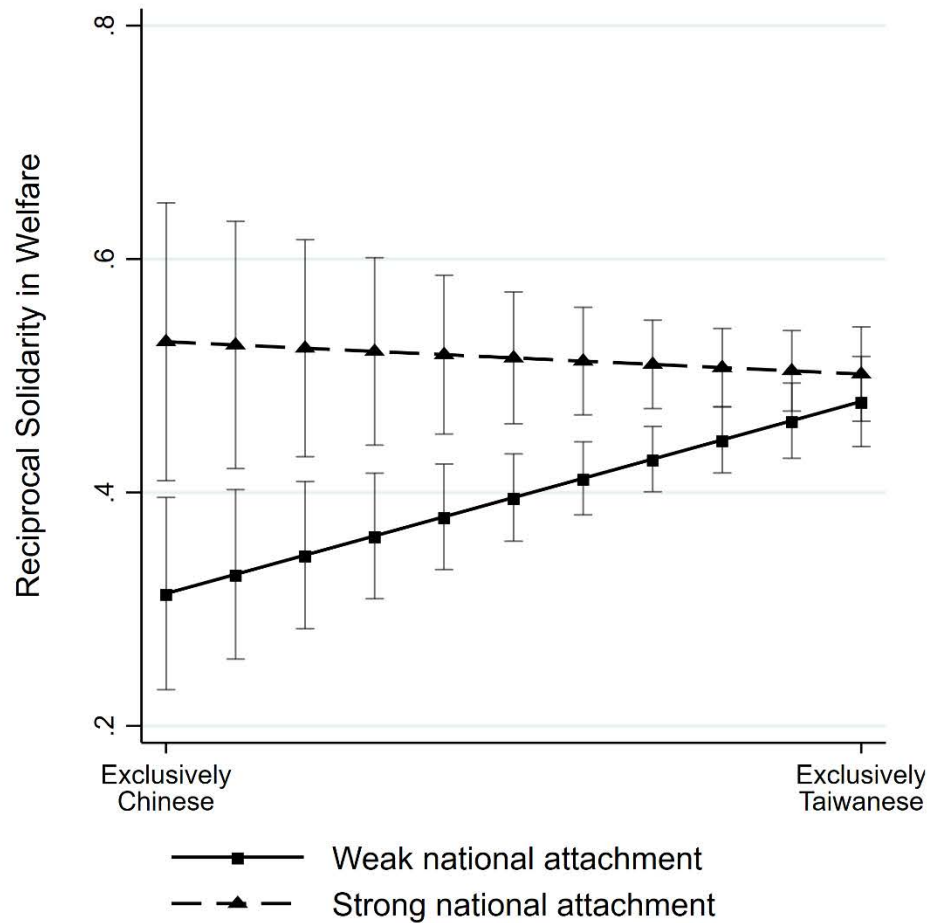


Table S1. Correlation Matrix

Variables	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
(1) Reciprocal solidarity in welfare	1.00									
(2) Reciprocal solidarity in warfare	0.35	1.00								
(3) National attachment	0.17	0.27	1.00							
(4) National identity	0.09	0.24	0.09	1.00						
(5) Social trust	0.01	0.07	0.04	0.01	1.00					
(6) Belief in meritocracy	-0.05	-0.03	0.01	0.02	-0.17	1.00				
(7) Perceived NHI bankruptcy risk	-0.09	-0.06	-0.10	-0.05	0.05	-0.03	1.00			
(8) Perceived war risk	-0.03	-0.08	0.01	-0.05	0.02	-0.00	0.20	1.00		
(9) Personal income	-0.02	0.02	0.05	-0.05	0.12	-0.06	0.03	0.05	1.00	
(10) Number of children	-0.00	0.01	-0.00	-0.02	0.09	0.00	0.06	-0.03	0.18	1.00

Table S2. Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) Regression of Reciprocal Solidarity in Welfare (Full Results)
(n=1025)

	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
National attachment	1.052*** (0.200)		0.800*** (0.212)		0.201*** (0.040)	0.156*** (0.042)
National identity		0.593** (0.206)		0.466* (0.234)	0.100* (0.041)	0.085 (0.046)
Female (ref: male)			-0.309** (0.111)	-0.298** (0.112)		-0.063** (0.022)
Age group (ref: <30)						
30-39			0.014 (0.194)	0.067 (0.197)		-0.000 (0.039)
40-49			0.278 (0.196)	0.436* (0.195)		0.061 (0.039)
50-59			0.177 (0.188)	0.377* (0.187)		0.045 (0.038)
60-69			0.427* (0.210)	0.605** (0.212)		0.091* (0.042)
>=70			0.587* (0.231)	0.761*** (0.230)		0.123** (0.046)
Educational level (ref: junior high and below)						
Senior high			0.181 (0.216)	0.295 (0.213)		0.038 (0.043)
College			0.054 (0.228)	0.155 (0.227)		0.014 (0.046)
Graduate			0.407 (0.267)	0.517 (0.266)		0.083 (0.053)
Work status (ref: full-time)						
Part-time			-0.134 (0.222)	-0.071 (0.223)		-0.022 (0.044)
Employers			-0.079 (0.211)	-0.052 (0.213)		-0.014 (0.042)
Not in labor force			0.131 (0.149)	0.166 (0.151)		0.031 (0.030)
Personal income			-0.386 (0.340)	-0.333 (0.343)		-0.071 (0.068)
Self-reported health status			0.154 (0.269)	0.220 (0.270)		0.026 (0.054)
Number of children			0.068 (0.234)	0.045 (0.236)		0.016 (0.047)
Partisanship (ref: independent)						
Pan-green			0.293* (0.128)	0.296* (0.131)		0.043 (0.026)
Pan-blue			-0.083 (0.151)	-0.013 (0.155)		-0.002 (0.031)
White			0.092 (0.222)	0.082 (0.220)		0.017 (0.044)
Social trust			0.071 (0.190)	0.098 (0.192)		0.015 (0.038)
Perceived NHI bankruptcy risk			-0.168 (0.198)	-0.184 (0.199)		-0.031 (0.040)
Belief in meritocracy			-0.263 (0.188)	-0.257 (0.190)		-0.055 (0.038)
Constant	2.527*** (0.161)	2.875*** (0.172)	2.547*** (0.382)	2.467*** (0.420)	0.234*** (0.043)	0.241*** (0.085)
Adjusted R-squared	0.027	0.008	0.051	0.041	0.032	0.054

Standard errors in parentheses.

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table S3. Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) Regression of Reciprocal Solidarity in Warfare (Full Results)
(n=1025)

	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
National attachment	1.730*** (0.206)		1.412*** (0.216)		0.320*** (0.041)	0.273*** (0.043)
National identity		1.580*** (0.218)		1.084*** (0.252)	0.286*** (0.043)	0.201*** (0.049)
Female (ref: male)			-0.376*** (0.108)	-0.358** (0.109)		-0.077*** (0.021)
Age group (ref: <30)						
30-39			0.141 (0.207)	0.226 (0.213)		0.022 (0.041)
40-49			0.444* (0.198)	0.742*** (0.199)		0.101* (0.039)
50-59			0.209 (0.195)	0.595** (0.194)		0.066 (0.039)
60-69			0.332 (0.217)	0.673** (0.217)		0.080 (0.043)
>=70			0.380 (0.225)	0.715** (0.228)		0.089* (0.044)
Educational level (ref: junior high and below)						
Senior high			0.018 (0.202)	0.215 (0.203)		0.007 (0.040)
College			0.005 (0.218)	0.186 (0.223)		0.009 (0.044)
Graduate			0.053 (0.255)	0.240 (0.259)		0.015 (0.051)
Work status (ref: full-time)						
Part-time			-0.377 (0.245)	-0.251 (0.254)		-0.064 (0.048)
Employers			-0.126 (0.203)	-0.077 (0.203)		-0.022 (0.040)
Not in labor force			-0.023 (0.146)	0.051 (0.148)		0.006 (0.029)
Personal income			-0.143 (0.349)	-0.034 (0.341)		-0.015 (0.068)
Self-reported health status			-0.045 (0.270)	0.067 (0.273)		-0.019 (0.054)
Number of children			-0.119 (0.235)	-0.149 (0.246)		-0.017 (0.047)
Partisanship (ref: independent)						
Pan-green			0.664*** (0.122)	0.623*** (0.130)		0.097*** (0.026)
Pan-blue			-0.436** (0.168)	-0.267 (0.173)		-0.052 (0.034)
White			0.118 (0.228)	0.092 (0.227)		0.022 (0.045)
Social trust			0.317 (0.190)	0.366 (0.193)		0.065 (0.038)
Perceived war risk			-0.476* (0.234)	-0.386 (0.232)		-0.088 (0.046)
Belief in meritocracy			-0.095 (0.186)	-0.091 (0.190)		-0.024 (0.037)
Constant	2.783*** (0.170)	2.876*** (0.186)	3.037*** (0.377)	2.629*** (0.428)	0.151*** (0.043)	0.246** (0.084)
Adjusted R-squared	0.070	0.057	0.132	0.110	0.116	0.148

Standard errors in parentheses.

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table S4. Interaction Effects of National Attachment and National Identity on Reciprocal Solidarity: Welfare vs. Warfare (Full Results) (n=1025)

	Reciprocity in Welfare		Reciprocity in Warfare	
	Coef.	(S.E)	Coef.	(S.E)
High nationalism (ref: low nationalism)	0.216**	(0.070)	0.139	(0.076)
National identity: exclusively Taiwanese (ref: exclusively Chinese)	0.165**	(0.053)	0.196**	(0.060)
High nationalism	-0.192*	(0.083)	-0.016	(0.088)
*national identity: exclusively Taiwanese				
Female (ref: male)	-0.067**	(0.022)	-0.075***	(0.022)
Age group (ref: <30)				
30-39	0.002	(0.039)	0.022	(0.042)
40-49	0.077*	(0.039)	0.118**	(0.040)
50-59	0.059	(0.038)	0.079*	(0.039)
60-69	0.106*	(0.042)	0.090*	(0.044)
>=70	0.131**	(0.046)	0.096*	(0.045)
Educational level (ref: junior high and below)				
Senior High	0.052	(0.043)	0.028	(0.040)
College	0.023	(0.045)	0.028	(0.044)
Graduate	0.097	(0.053)	0.031	(0.051)
Work status (ref: full-time)				
Part-time	-0.020	(0.044)	-0.066	(0.049)
Employers	-0.015	(0.042)	-0.028	(0.041)
Not in labor force	0.028	(0.030)	0.000	(0.029)
Personal income	-0.079	(0.069)	-0.012	(0.069)
Self-reported health status	0.033	(0.054)	-0.008	(0.054)
Number of children	0.010	(0.046)	-0.024	(0.048)
Partisanship (ref: independent)				
Pan-green	0.052*	(0.026)	0.103***	(0.026)
Pan-blue	-0.010	(0.031)	-0.061	(0.034)
White	0.011	(0.044)	0.013	(0.045)
Social trust	0.023	(0.038)	0.074	(0.038)
Belief in meritocracy	-0.053	(0.038)	-0.025	(0.038)
Perceived NHI bankruptcy risk	-0.025	(0.040)		
Perceived war risk			-0.072	(0.046)
Constant	0.245**	(0.086)	0.363***	(0.088)
Adjusted R-squared	0.052		0.136	

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$